Pine Valley Special Services District Meeting
March 6, 2024

Attending Board Members: Mary Esther Putnam, Chairwoman; Bob Dalley, Vice-Chairman; Allen Cannon, Emily Neilson, Steve Shakespeare
Attending PVSSD Assistants: Rick Peetz, Treasurer; LaDawn Christensen, Secretary
Fire Chief: Robert Hardy
Attending Guests: Herman Nordbruch, Tom Neilsen, Rob Nodine, Rick Albee, Brian Davis, Claudia Davis, Scott Dunkleman, Ralph Flores, Rosemary D'Amato, Frank Davie, Gene Phillips

Welcome: Mary Esther called the meeting to order. Central guests Ralph Flores, Central Fire Chief, and Rosemary D'Amato, board member for Northwestern Special Service District, were welcomed.

> Mary Esther thanked the outgoing board members Herman Nordbruch and Mike Stucki for their input, time, and contributions to the board. She welcomed new board members Steve Shakespeare and Emily Nielson. Allen Cannon has been reappointed and will continue with the board for four years. Mary Esther and Bob have another two years remaining on their term.

Mary Esther appointed Allen to continue working on and reporting on the community center, Emily on any building/zoning issues, and Steve on roads, snow removal, and working with the fire chief.

Allen proposed that Mary Esther continue as board chairman, all in favor.

February 2024 Meeting Minutes: Allen approved the minutes, Steve seconded, and all were in favor.

Board Member Reports:

> Steven reported that during his board interview with the county, they mentioned that the individual SSDs are not keeping up with their fire department's old equipment and gaining new volunteers. Their main concern is increasing assessment fees due to inflation and sustainability. While there are substantial funds in our savings accounts, they have been seriously depleted with past projects, and there are not sufficient funds for the 2024 radio requirement and required new equipment, including the long-term need to replace engines or transmissions.

Fire Chief Report: Robert reported eleven total calls last month, seven in Central and four in Pine Valley. Two fire calls and nine EMT calls. Four hundred and eight fire and EMS volunteer hours were reported.

Robert noted that the Utah House of Representatives approved fire and EMS in rural areas under a population of 3,000 to receive state health insurance. If qualified, Pine Valley EMS and fire volunteers will be able to receive the insurance. The governor must sign off on it, and it would be effective July 1st, 2024.

Short-Term Rental (STR) Fire Inspections: No updates

Community Center: Allen contacted the county commissioners regarding the Forest Service land swap, but there are no new developments to report.

2024 Budget Revision

1. **Fee Assessment**

2. **Fire Department Volunteer Remuneration**

The board approved rolling over the 2023 budget into 2024 in November and reviewing it again in March of this year due to the possible delay of the consolidated North Mountain SSD formation this year. The county commissioners announced last month that that they will not consolidate the Mountain District SSD's

In February's meeting, Fire Chief Hardy proposed a monetary incentive for the fire and EMS volunteers based on their training time and call-out responses. The incentive is modest and does not exceed $599 per volunteer a year, and they would no longer be exempt from paying the yearly assessment. Chief Hardy sent the estimated figures to the board on the maximum payout for this year using 2023 volunteer hours as a basis. Those assumptions would create a total estimated modest increase in the 2024 budget of about $8,000. Volunteers would also be assessed the standard home and other assessments. This remuneration would offset all or part of those assessments depending on the volunteer's level of act out. Bob motioned, and Allen seconded the approval of this modest remuneration of volunteers, all in favor.

The board discussed the proposed increase fee assessment in detail. The fire department's equipment is aging and requires maintenance; new radios will be required this year, and inflation is an issue. The department is diligently applying for grants and will seek help from private donors.

To fund the required radio purchases and to rebuild a capital fund for antiquated equipment, it was proposed that the annual home assessment be increased to $270, with $20 going to the PVLAD and the lot assessment rising from $50 to $100. Applying the same percentage increase as the home assessment, a required assessment of $ 475 for short-term rentals was required. Further, the annual fire inspection fee of $200 will also be added to the short-term rentals assessment. Bob approved, Steve seconded, and all were in favor.

Treasurer Report (January and February): January finances were provided in last month's meeting. Rick reported the February finances. Bob approved, Steve seconded, and all were in favor.

Citizen Requests: None

The next scheduled PVSSD meeting will be on April 3, 2024. PVSSD Board Meeting adjourned.